



INTERNAL HDDs: WESTERN DIGITAL VELOCIRAPTOR 600GB

Price: ₹17,599

Internal HDDs

Hard drives went up in capacity this year. All three major manufacturers viz. Western Digital, Hitachi and Seagate now have their 3TB versions. With the WD drive, you needed a host bus adapter (which came bundled) to use the full 3TB capacity. Also a term that was heard quite often was advanced 4K format, which basically combines eight 512-byte sectors to prevent the 2.19TB barrier limit that was present in previous generation hard drives. Seagate had a 3TB drive using the 512-byte sector to make it compatible with older systems running Windows XP.

Zero1 Winner

Western Digital Velociraptor 600GB

When it came to pure performance, the WD Velociraptor 600 GB drive which came with a SATA 6 Gbps interface and having 32 MB of cache won hands down, thanks to the massive 10,000 RPM spindle speed. With read speeds crossing 150 MB/s and write speeds around 148 MB/s, the Velociraptor had little competition and is the drive to go for if you want blazing speeds, but don't have the budget to invest in an SSD.

Worthy Mentions

Seagate Barracuda XT 3TB

This is one drive that did manage to come close to the performance of the WD Velociraptor. The humongous capacity ensures that the cost per GB remains low. Also unlike the WD 3TB drive, the Barracuda XT doesn't need a host bus adapter to utilise the complete 3TB capacity of the drive.



Seagate Barracuda XT 3TB

Price: ₹14,500



Corsair Force 3 GT 120GB

Price: ₹9,999

SSDs

Just like their mechanical counterparts, the solid state drives also started to see an increase in overall capacity. With increased capacity and prices coming down, the SSD market is really hot now. From just two companies making the controllers a couple of years back – Intel and Indilinx, to many more now – Jmicron, Toshiba, Marvell, SandForce and Samsung, among others. The Performance of SSDs with the same controller have limited variation and we got to see a difference only when the controllers were different.

Zero1 Winner

Kingston HyperX 240GB SSD

“Blazing fast” are the only words that come to mind when you talk about this beautifully designed high capacity SSD. Performance-wise, it was superior to any other SSD we tested this year. Kingston has moved from the Toshiba controllers (seen in Kingston SSDNow V+100) to SandForce SF2281 controller. The performance upgrade is tremendous with real life Read/Write scores at 263 / 203 MB/s. But this drive comes at a massive cost per GB of ₹125.23.

Worthy Mentions

Corsair Force 3 GT 120GB

Corsair Force 3 GT 120 GB drive sports the SandForce SF2281 controller. Performance is top notch, thanks to the same controller as is being used in the Zero1 Winner. Best part is that it comes at a very promising price point.



SSDs: KINGSTON HYPERX 240GB SSD

Price: ₹27,999